

Persona 1: Maya Chen

Public Data Explorer



Bio

Maya Chen is a 21-year-old undergraduate journalism student interested in elections, campaign finance, and democratic transparency. She is comfortable using websites, maps, filters, and basic charts, but has no experience with programming, GIS, or raw data cleaning. She wants CDMP to help her quickly explore political donation patterns by party, year, and geography without needing to download or process Elections Canada data herself.

Profile

Age	21
Education	Bachelor's student in Journalism
Occupation	Full-time student
Location	Toronto, Ontario
Tech literacy	Medium
Access level	Public, no login required
Data visibility	Aggregated and anonymized donation data only
Platform	Browser-based web app
Personality tags	Reader, Extrovert, Curious

Primary Task

Quickly find a political donation pattern that could support a story, article, or class assignment.

User Story

As a journalism student, I want to filter political donations by party, year, and geographic level so that I can quickly identify donation patterns for a story or class assignment.

Core Needs

- Quickly generate a meaningful donation map without needing technical setup.
- Filter donation data by party, year, and geographic level.
- Click on a region to view clear summary statistics and trends.
- Understand the map through simple labels, legends, and explanations.

- Avoid working directly with raw CSV files, postal code matching, or GIS tools.
- Trust that the data is presented accurately, with clear notes for missing, suppressed, or limited data.

Frustrations

- Elections Canada donation data is difficult to find, download, and understand.
- Raw CSV files require too much manual cleaning before they become useful.
- She does not know how to match postal codes to electoral districts.
- Existing data does not immediately show geographic patterns visually.
- She may not know whether donation totals are misleading without population context.
- She needs quick, clear results because her work is often deadline driven.

Quote

"I need to quickly see whether there is a donation pattern worth writing about, without spending hours cleaning data first."

Success Criteria

Maya succeeds if she can open CDMP, apply basic filters, view a meaningful map, click a region, and understand whether there is a pattern worth investigating.

Persona 2: Amira Hassan

Civic Transparency Communicator



Bio

Amira Hassan is a 34-year-old program coordinator at a civic-engagement nonprofit in Ottawa. She creates public education materials about elections, democracy, and political transparency. She wants to use CDMP to explain broad donation patterns through clear, privacy-safe maps that community members, volunteers, and students can easily understand.

Profile

Age	34
Education	Bachelor's degree in Political Science
Occupation	Program Coordinator at a civic-engagement nonprofit
Location	Ottawa, Ontario
Tech literacy	Medium
Access level	Public, no login required
Data visibility	Aggregated and anonymized donation data only
Platform	Browser-based web app
Personality tags	Educator, Transparent, Responsible

Primary Task

Use aggregated donation maps to explain political finance patterns to a non-technical public audience.

User Story

As a civic transparency communicator, I want to view privacy-safe aggregated donation maps so that I can explain political finance patterns to the public.

Core Needs

- View donation patterns in a simple, visual format.
- Compare donations by region, party, and year.
- Use privacy-safe aggregated data without exposing individual donors.
- Explain political finance trends to non-technical audiences.
- Access clear map legends, labels, and summary statistics.

- Trust that the platform presents data responsibly and avoids misleading interpretations.

Frustrations

- Raw donation data is too technical for public education.
- Spreadsheets and complex charts are hard to explain to non-technical audiences.
- She does not want to expose individual donor information.
- She needs clear legends, labels, and plain-language summaries.
- It can be difficult to compare regions fairly without context like population size.
- She worries that users may misread the map if the data limits are not explained clearly.

Quote

"I want to help people understand where political donations come from, but I need the data shown in a clear and privacy-safe way."

Success Criteria

Amira succeeds if she can use CDMP to explain donation patterns to a non-technical audience without exposing individual donor records or doing manual data processing.

Persona 3: Daniel Roy

Authenticated Research Assistant



Bio

Daniel Roy is a 26-year-old political science graduate research assistant working with a university research group in Toronto. He studies the spatial distribution of political finance in Canada and needs access to detailed donation records for academic research. Unlike public users, Daniel sometimes needs to view individual-level records, including donor names, donation amounts, dates, political entities, and postal codes.

Profile

Age	26
Education	Master's student in Political Science
Occupation	Political Science Graduate Research Assistant
Location	Toronto, Ontario
Tech literacy	High
Access level	Authenticated research user, login required
Data visibility	Individual-level donation records with privacy protections
Platform	Browser-based web app
Personality tags	Analytical, Detail-oriented, Responsible

Primary Task

Search and analyze individual-level donation records for academic research while respecting privacy and audit requirements.

User Story

As an authenticated research assistant, I want to access individual-level donation records through a secure login so that I can conduct detailed political finance research with appropriate privacy controls.

Core Needs

- Securely log in to the research tier.
- Search and filter individual-level donation records.
- Analyze donations by party, date, amount, postal code, and electoral district.
- Compare detailed records with aggregate map patterns.

- Understand which geographic boundary data is being used.
- Use individual-level data responsibly with privacy protections and audit logging.

Frustrations

- Current research workflows rely too much on scripts and programming knowledge.
- Individual-level records create privacy and access-control concerns.
- Postal code errors can affect the accuracy of geographic analysis.
- Electoral boundaries have changed over time, which makes comparisons harder.
- Public aggregate views may hide details needed for deeper research.
- It can be difficult to trust results without clear data source and boundary information.

Quote

“The public map helps me find patterns, but my research sometimes requires the underlying records.”

Success Criteria

Daniel succeeds if he can log in, search individual-level records, connect them to map-based patterns, and understand the data context well enough to support research work.